🛡️ GHOST: User Setup & Connection Guide

This application is a standalone, portable **P2P** communication tool. It does not require installation. All data is stored within its own folder, and all communications are routed through the **Tor Network** for maximum anonymity.

📋 Prerequisites

System Clock: Ensure your computer's time and date are set to Automatic. **Tor** will fail to connect if your system clock is off by more than a few minutes.

Firewall: When you first run the app, Windows may ask for Permission to communicate on the network. Allow Access for both Private and Public networks to enable **P2P (WebRTC)** connections.

🚀 Step 1: Initial Launch & Security

Unzip the **GHOST.zip** folder to a permanent location (e.g., C:\GHOST\) or USB. Do not run the app directly from the .zip file, as it needs to write to its local database.

Double-click to launch.

Ensure you are connected to the internet for the initial activation.

Enter the License Key provided in your **PayHip** receipt.

Set a Master Password: On your first run, you will be prompted to create a Master Password.

⚠️ **Warning:** This password encrypts your local database. If you lose it, your contacts and message history cannot be recovered.

📖 Step 1A: Handling Anti-Virus "False Positives"

Because **GHOST** is obfuscated to protect its proprietary signaling code and uses **Tor-routing**, some Anti-Virus software (like Windows Defender) may flag the .exe as "Unknown" or "Suspicious."

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Why this happens: To keep the network decentralized, the app contains its own **Tor** binary. Standard AV tools often flag bundled binaries they don't recognize.

The Fix: If the app is blocked, click **"More Info"** on the Windows popup and select **"Run Anyway."** For a smoother experience, we recommend adding the **GHOST** folder to your Anti-Virus "Exclusion" or "Whitelist."

🧅 Step 2: Your Identity & Signal Status

Once the app opens, look at the Sidebar (left side):

MY ID: Your unique alphanumeric **"Ghost ID"** is displayed at the top of the sidebar and in the window title bar.
You must copy and paste it somewhere and share this ID with others so they can call you.

SIGNALS Status: Below your ID, a colored indicator shows the connection to the signaling relays via **Tor**.

Checking: The app is attempting to reach the servers through **Tor**.

Online (Green): You are ready to make or receive calls.

Offline (Red): Tor is still bootstrapping or the signaling servers are unreachable.

🤝 Step 3: Managing Contacts

To connect with someone, you must first add them to your local database:

Click the **ADD PEER** button at the bottom of the sidebar.

Enter an **Alias** (a nickname for your contact) and their **Ghost ID**.

The contact will now appear in your sidebar list.

📞 Step 4: Video Calling & Chat

To Call: Click on a contact's name in the sidebar and press the green **CALL PEER** button.

The center window will display your remote peer's video once they accept the connection.

To end the session, click the red **STOP CALL** button.

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To Chat: Use the **MESSAGES** panel on the right.

Type your message in the bottom input field and press **Enter** to send.

Your conversation history is displayed in the panel above the input.

☢️ Step 5: The Panic Wipe

If your security is compromised, use the **PANIC WIPE (ALT+X)** button at the bottom left.

Action: Clicking this button (or pressing **Alt+X**) immediately closes the app and permanently deletes your **ghost.db** contact list and **vault.salt** encryption file.

Result: All data is erased, and the app is reset to a "first-run" state.

🛠️ Common Troubleshooting

Issue	Solution
"Tor binary not found"	Ensure the tor.exe file is located inside a folder named tor next to the app.
Signals 0/2 Online	Tor is likely still building circuits. Wait 1-2 minutes for the initial connection.
"Feed Stopped"	This is the default state when no active call is in progress.
Can't Send Message	You can only send messages once a peer has accepted your call and the data tunnel is open.

Contact: For formal security audits or B2B infrastructure inquiries, Contact Email .